

1 GIST

Follow the emotional or meaningful thread in someone's message with a short reflection and natural question.

Not: asking lots of questions. Do: track what feels alive.

2 INFLUENCE PAYOFF

- Increases warmth, trust and flow.
- Makes people feel seen, interesting and understood.
- Builds receptiveness before persuasion.
- Unlocks richer stories and useful specifics.

3 BEST USE CASES

- Rapport, small talk, dating, networking.
- Conflict-softening and understanding before persuasion.
- Early-stage conversations when you want warmth and flow.
- Moments when someone says something charged, specific or interesting.

4 AVOID WHEN

- They are rushed or giving short answers.
- The topic is too private for the relationship depth.
- You are already asking too many questions.
- You are steering, prying, or sounding analytical.

5 WHY IT WORKS

People feel seen when you reflect their meaning and emotion. A precise follow-up signals curiosity + respect, inviting them to open up more.

Influence principle: people become more receptive after they first feel you have been receptive to them.

HOW TO DO IT: OPERATING SEQUENCE			NOTICE -> COMMENT -> ASK -> REFLECT -> CONTRIBUTE		
1 CATCH THE LIVE THREAD Listen for energy: "honestly", "weirdly", "the annoying part", "I didn't expect", "It sounds silly, but..."	2 COMMENT BEFORE ASKING Warm the question: "Weirdly intense sounds specific. What made it intense?"	3 ASK ONE CONNECTED QUESTION Short, easy, connected to their words, warm rather than analytical. Avoid question-stacking.	4 USE THE DEPTH DIAL Light -> warm -> personal -> meaningful -> intimate. Everyday charisma usually lives in warm + personal.	5 REFLECT BRIEFLY "So the hard part was less the work and more figuring out the people." Shows you listened and invites detail.	6 CONTRIBUTE AFTER CURIOSITY After one or two follow-ups, share a small related thought so it stays conversational.

7 CORE FORMULA

Charged detail
+ small comment
+ one natural question

Keep it about them first.

✓ EXAMPLES OF GOOD COMMENTS

- "You said it was weirdly intense. Weirdly intense how?"
- "That sounds like it mattered. What made it important?"
- "You seemed to light up there. What do you like about it?"
- "Did that change how you felt, or what you decided?"
- "That's a surprising twist."

⬆️ DEPTH DIAL

LIGHT

Surface details & events.

What happened next?

WARM

Feelings, opinions, preference.

What was that like?

PERSONAL

Values, meaning, inside perspective.

What did that mean to you?

INTIMATE

Core beliefs, wounds, dreams, fears.

What changed for you?

Rule:

match the level they are offering. Do not jump deeper to seem insightful.

! MINIMUM MOVE

Pick their loaded word and ask:

[word] how?

Examples: Weird how? Intense how? Unexpected how?

PHRASE BANK (PICK, ADAPT, MAKE IT SOUND LIKE YOU)			
QUICK OPENERS "What was that like?" "How did that happen?" "What happened next?" "What made that stand out?" "How did it go from there?" "What part is different this time?"	TWO-OPTION CHOICES "Exciting-intense or stressful-intense?" "Better or more interesting?" "The idea or the experience?" "Change your mind or confirm what you thought?" "Good-surprise or complicated surprise?" "Good-weird or bad-weird?"	SOCIAL / DATING "What makes you lose track of time?" "What are you weirdly passionate about?" "What's the most 'you' thing you've done lately?" "What do people usually get wrong about you?" "What kind of person brings out your best side?"	WARM "That sounds like it mattered." "What was going through your head?" "What was the best part of that?" "What was the hardest part?" "Did that hit harder than expected?" "That sounds like it stayed with you."
PROFESSIONAL "What led you to that decision?" "What was the key factor?" "What constraint were you working around?" "What surprised you, good or not so good?" "What would make the next step easier?"	CONFLICT-SOFTENING "What part of this feels most important to you?" "What are you worried I'm not seeing?" "What would feel fair from your side?" "What did that mean to you when it happened?" "What do you need me to understand before I respond?"	DIGITAL / TEXT "Curious - what made you choose that?" "What's the short version and the honest version?" "Was that good-intense or bad-intense?" "What happened after that?" "What's the part you're still thinking about?"	CHARISMATIC FINISHERS "There's a detail in that I want to ask about." "That sounds like the interesting part." "That sentence is doing a lot of work." "I feel like there's a story behind that." "You can't drop that detail and move on." "What would people miss from the outside?"